

The PetHealthNotes Starter Kit

By Vishal, Founder of PetHealthNotes

The ultimate 2-page cheatsheet to organizing your dog's health and handling emergencies.

Part 1: The Emergency Fridge Cheatsheet

Print this page and tape it to your refrigerator.

1. Know Your Dog's Baseline Vitals

Write these down when your dog is healthy and resting.

- **Resting Heart Rate:** ____ BPM (Normal: 60-140 based on size)
- **Breathing Rate:** ____ Breaths/Min (Normal: 10-30. Over 40 while resting is an emergency)
- **Gum Color:** ____ (Should be bubblegum pink. White, blue, or dark red is an emergency)
- **Weight:** ____ lbs/kg (Date weighed: ____)

2. The 3-Second Capillary Refill Test

If you think your dog is sick, press your thumb firmly into their pink gums until the spot turns white, then release.

- **Normal:** The pink color should return in **under 2 seconds**.
- **Emergency:** If it takes 3+ seconds to turn pink again, they are experiencing poor circulation or shock. Go to the ER.

3. Toxic Foods & Items to Avoid

- Xylitol (Birch Sugar) - Found in sugar-free gum & peanut butter. Highly fatal.
- Grapes & Raisins - Causes rapid kidney failure.
- Macadamia Nuts & Onions/Garlic.
- Ibuprofen/Advil - NEVER give human painkillers to dogs.

4. Emergency Contacts

- **Primary Vet:** _____
 - **24/7 Emergency Vet:** _____
 - **Pet Poison Helpline:** (855) 764-7661 (Keep a credit card ready)
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Part 2: The Vet-Ready Record Checklist

Use this checklist to organize your records before your next vet visit.

When your dog gets sick, you only get 15 minutes with the vet. Do not waste that time trying to remember what month they started limping.

- ☐ **Create a Timeline:** Write down the exact date you first noticed the symptom. "He started limping on Tuesday morning" is much better than "He's been limping for a while."
 - ☐ **Film the Symptom:** If they are coughing, limping, or shaking, take a 10-second video. Dogs often hide their symptoms in the exam room because they are scared. The video is proof.
 - ☐ **List All Current Medications/Supplements:** Write down the exact brand names, milligrams (mg), and time of day you give them. (e.g., "Dasuquin with MSM, 1 chew at 8 AM").
 - ☐ **Diet Details:** Know the exact brand and protein source of their food (e.g., "Purina Pro Plan Sensitive Skin & Stomach - Salmon").
 - ☐ **Use the PetHealthNotes App:** Plug all of these symptoms and medications into the free PetHealthNotes tracker app to generate a clean, 1-page PDF report to hand to the vet receptionist.
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Need more help navigating a diagnosis? Join the community at PetHealthNotes.com